Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Missed Appointments

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: CP2018010
Related policies: N/A

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Overview

This policy outlines Humana's expectations for a provider charging a patient for a missed appointment.

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Humana Medicare Advantage (MA) plans recognize that a provider can charge a patient for a missed appointment, as long as the provider applies their policy according to the standards outlined in Chapter 1, Section 30.3.13 of the Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Therefore, a provider must apply any policy regarding a missed appointment equally to all patients, whether they are enrolled in the Medicare Program or not. A missed appointment fee must be the same for Medicare beneficiaries and patients who are not Medicare beneficiaries. The fee is not a charge for a health care service but compensates the provider for a missed business opportunity.

A hospital may charge a patient for a missed appointment in the hospital's outpatient department only if the patient is not receiving inpatient services at the time of the missed appointment. The hospital would violate 42 CFR 489.22 if it were to charge a registered hospital inpatient a fee for missing an appointment in the hospital's outpatient department.

Consistent with Original Medicare, Humana MA plans do not reimburse for a missed appointment charge imposed by a provider. A missed appointment fee should not be billed to Humana. If a provider submits a charge to Humana for a missed appointment fee, Humana will deny the charge, indicating the service is not covered under the patient's MA plan.

References

- U.S. Government Publishing Office website. Code of Federal Regulations. Title 42. Section 489.22 – Special Provisions Applicable to Prepayment Requirements. www.ecfr.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 1 – General Billing Requirements. Section 30.3.13 – Charges for Missed Appointments. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Managed Care Manual. Chapter 4 – Benefits and Beneficiary Protections. Section 50.5 – Guidance on Other Enrollee Out-of-Pocket Liability. www.cms.gov.
- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. MLN Matters® Number: MM5613 Revised. www.cms.gov.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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